

FREE WEEKLY STUDY GUIDE

DEVOTION
in Season

WEEK 1 OF 8 · 4 TO 9 OCTOBER 2026

Integrity at Work

When the World Keeps a Standard the Church Dropped

SERIES: THE INFLUENTIAL SPIRIT
FOR PERSONAL STUDY, SMALL GROUPS AND TEAMS AT WORK

with Eryeza Kalalu

BEFORE YOU BEGIN

This Week at a Glance

This guide goes with Sunday's podcast and the five Devotion in Season Daily episodes that follow it. On your own it takes about twenty minutes. With a small group or a team at work, allow about forty-five. Read the passages slowly, answer the questions honestly, then finish with the practice and the prayer.

Sometimes people with no faith keep a standard believers have let fall. God shows us that gap so He can heal it, and the Holy Spirit closes it from the inside.

SUN 4 OCT	Podcast: Integrity at Work: When the World Keeps a Standard the Church Dropped	<i>1 Corinthians 5 · Matthew 5:13</i>
MON 5 OCT	When the World Has Higher Standards Than Christians	<i>1 Corinthians 5:1</i>
TUE 6 OCT	What Does "Salt of the Earth" Mean?	<i>Matthew 5:13</i>
WED 7 OCT	Can People Do Right Without Knowing God?	<i>Romans 2:14–15</i>
THU 8 OCT	Small Lies at Work: Do They Really Matter?	<i>Luke 16:10</i>
FRI 9 OCT	A Prayer to Be Salt Again	<i>Mark 9:50</i>

The podcast comes out on Sundays at 8 PM East Africa Time, around midday on the US East Coast. Devotion in Season Daily comes out Monday to Friday at 6 AM East Africa Time, which is the evening before in the United States. Watch or listen on YouTube, Spotify and eryezakalalu.com.

READ

The Passages

“It is actually reported that there is sexual immorality among you, and such sexual immorality as is not even named among the Gentiles.”

“And you are puffed up, and have not rather mourned...”

“Do you not know that a little leaven leavens the whole lump?”

“For indeed Christ, our Passover, was sacrificed for us.”

1 CORINTHIANS 5:1–2, 6–7 · NKJV

What it meant first. Corinth was a wealthy port city in Greece, known across the Roman world for its loose living. Paul planted the church there and stayed a year and a half (Acts 18:11). He then heard that a man in the church was living with his father’s wife, something even the pagan city would not accept, and the church was tolerating it. Paul was dealing with one real case of sexual sin. In this guide we apply the principle to our working lives: when God’s people fall below a standard unbelievers keep, Christ’s name is dishonoured with ours. Leaven is yeast; a pinch spreads through the whole loaf.

“You are the salt of the earth; but if the salt loses its flavor, how shall it be seasoned? It is then good for nothing but to be thrown out and trampled underfoot by men.”

MATTHEW 5:13 · NKJV

What it meant first. Jesus spoke these words to His followers in the Sermon on the Mount. Salt did two jobs His listeners knew well: it gave food flavour, and before refrigeration it kept fish and meat from going bad. He describes people who already belong to Him. Being salt starts with who we are in Christ, and the Holy Spirit keeps us salty.

MY NOTES

REFLECT

Five Questions

The questions move from easy to costly. In a group, give people time to answer, and let anyone pass who needs to. Please leave out names when you share stories.

1. Have you ever watched someone with no faith act with more integrity than a believer? What happened, and how did it make you feel?
2. The church in Corinth was “puffed up” about something Paul says it should have mourned. Why do you think a group can grow comfortable with what it ought to grieve over?
3. Paul writes that “a little leaven leavens the whole lump.” What shortcut is accepted where you work, and what has it taught people about the real rules?
4. Salt adds flavour and slows decay. Where could your presence at work do both this week?
5. Is there anything in the way you work, pay people or speak that a person with no faith might look at and say, “Even I wouldn’t do that”? What would it take to change it?

THE PRACTICE · ONE ACTION THIS WEEK

Find one small dishonest habit that everyone at your workplace accepts, and stop doing it. It could be padded mileage, a long lunch recorded as a meeting, or a friend pushed to the front of a queue. You can stop without announcing it.

THREE PLACES TO START

IF YOU RUN A BUSINESS

Pay your oldest unpaid invoice before the newest. If you can’t pay yet, phone that supplier and say honestly when you can.

IF YOU KEEP THE BOOKS

Find one entry that stands only because it favours you. Correct it this week and tell your manager why.

IF YOU WORK FOR SOMEONE

Next time you make a mistake in front of colleagues, say it out loud: “I got that wrong, and here’s how I’ll fix it.”

In Christ you already have God’s approval, so these are places where His Spirit can show His life in you. If one of the examples made you uneasy because you’ve already crossed that line, 1 John 1:9 is for you: “If we confess our sins, He is faithful and just to forgive us our sins and to cleanse us from all unrighteousness.”

GO DEEPER EACH MORNING

With the Daily Episodes

MON

When the World Has Higher Standards Than Christians · *1 Corinthians 5:1*

Where has the world around me kept a line that I have let slip?

TUE

What Does “Salt of the Earth” Mean? · *Matthew 5:13*

Where can I add flavour and slow the rot at work today?

WED

Can People Do Right Without Knowing God? · *Romans 2:14–15*

Who has God used to show me what is right, even though they don't know Him? How can I thank Him for that person?

THU

Small Lies at Work: Do They Really Matter? · *Luke 16:10*

What small untruth have I stopped noticing in my own speech?

FRI

A Prayer to Be Salt Again · *Mark 9:50*

Pray the prayer below slowly, and name one place where you want to be salt again.

PRAY

Lord Jesus, You see my whole week, the parts people notice and the parts they never see. Wherever I've let the salt go flat, I'm sorry. I don't want my faith to be for show. Holy Spirit, do in me what trying harder never could. Form Christ in me at my desk, in my accounts and in my messages. Give me the courage to count honestly when it costs me. In the mighty name of Jesus. Amen.

FROM THE BOOK

This week's theme opens *The Influential Spirit*, in the Introduction section “When the Collar No Longer Speaks for Us.” For a deeper look at integrity, read Day 23, “The Invisible Foundation.” The book comes in three editions at eryezakalalu.com, with launch prices until 31 October.

Support this ministry. If these devotions are feeding you, you can help keep them going at eryezakalalu.com/give.

Next week: Pressure: the deadline, the target and the shortcut that looks so easy. A young man named Daniel has a lot to teach us. The Week 2 guide will be at eryezakalalu.com/study.